Expense Policy

1. Business Expenses and Eligibility

This fictional expense policy explains how employees request reimbursement for reasonable costs incurred while performing approved business activities. Eligible costs may include necessary transport, lodging, and meals during a customer visit or authorized business trip. The expense should be appropriate to the business purpose and consistent with any project budget.

Personal purchases are not reimbursable. Examples include entertainment unrelated to work, traffic fines, minibar purchases, personal subscriptions, and expenses for family members. When a bill includes both business and personal items, the employee should identify the business portion and pay the personal portion separately where possible.

Employees should choose practical options and consider total cost, safety, travel time, and customer requirements. A manager should approve unusual or high-cost arrangements before they are booked. If an emergency prevents advance approval, the employee should explain the circumstances in the claim and contact the manager as soon as practical.

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2. Receipts and Claim Submission

Expense claims should be submitted in the expense system within 30 days of the purchase. Each line should include the transaction date, amount, currency, business purpose, project or cost center, and the names of attendees when relevant. Upload an itemized receipt that shows what was purchased, not only the card payment total.

If a receipt is unavailable, the employee should provide a short explanation and any other supporting record permitted by Finance. Altered receipts or estimates presented as original receipts are not acceptable. Claims with missing or unclear details may be returned for correction, which can delay reimbursement.

For travel claims, include itinerary details and explain the business purpose of the trip. For meals with customers, record the attendees and the meeting purpose. The claim should be submitted by the employee who incurred the expense, and the employee must confirm that the information is complete and accurate.

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3. Approval, Payment, and Exceptions

Manager approval is required for any single expense above 10,000 rupees in this example policy. The manager checks that the expense was business-related, reasonable, within budget, and supported by documentation. Employees must not approve their own claims. Finance performs a separate review for policy compliance and accounting requirements.

Approved claims are included in the next regular reimbursement cycle. The expense system shows whether a claim is pending, returned, approved, or paid. Employees who believe a claim is delayed should first check for a request for more information, then contact Finance with the claim reference number.

An exception should be requested before spending whenever possible. The request should state the reason, expected cost, and approving manager. Finance may ask for additional records or reject an expense that does not meet policy requirements. Suspected duplicate or inaccurate claims should be referred to Finance for review.

This document is a fictional training example, not an actual employer reimbursement promise.